

BM1 – Lesson 4: Paul & Silas

Faith in the Dark

 **Theme:** Praising God when life feels unfair

 **Background Text:** Acts 16:16–34

 **Key Verse:** Acts 16:25 (WEB)

“But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them.”

 **Appetizer – Doing Right and Still Getting Hurt, Acts 16:22–24 (WEB)**

²² The multitude rose up together against them, and the magistrates tore their clothes off of them, and commanded them to be beaten with rods.²³ When they had laid many stripes on them, they threw them into prison, charging the jailer to keep them safely, ²⁴ who, having received such a command, threw them into the inner prison, and secured their feet in the stocks.

Paul and Silas helped set a slave girl free from a spirit that was controlling her.

Instead of getting a “thank you,” they were:

- Stripped
- Beaten
- Thrown into the **inner prison**
- Locked in stocks

They were in pain for doing the **right** thing.

 **Reflection Question**

How do you usually react when you get in trouble or get hurt for doing something right?

Main Course

Bite 1 – Midnight Praise, Acts 16:25 (WEB)

“But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them.”

At their worst moment—midnight, in pain, chained—they choose to:

- **Pray**
- **Sing hymns to God**

Everyone else is listening. Their worship turns the prison into a **sanctuary**.

Reflection Question

If someone listened to you in your “midnight moments,” what would they hear—complaints, silence, or praise?

Bite 2 – The Shaking, Acts 16:26–28 (WEB)

²⁶ Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened and everyone’s bonds were loosened. ²⁷ The jailer, being awakened out of his sleep and seeing the prison doors open, drew his sword and was about to kill himself, supposing that the prisoners had escaped. ²⁸ But Paul cried with a loud voice, saying, “Don’t harm yourself, for we are all here!”

God answers in a wild way:

- Earthquake
- Open doors
- Loose chains

But the first miracle Paul and Silas walk in is **self-control**. They stay, not because they’re stuck, but because they see the jailer’s life is on the line.

Reflection Question

What does it say about Paul and Silas that they cared more about the jailer's life than their own escape?

Bite 3 – From Prison to Baptism, Acts 16:29–34 (WEB)

²⁹ He called for lights, sprang in, fell down trembling before Paul and Silas, ³⁰ and brought them out and said, "Sirs, what must I do to be saved?" ³¹ They said, "Believe in the Lord Jesus Christ, and you will be saved, you and your household." ³² They spoke the word of the Lord to him, and to all who were in his house. ³³ He took them the same hour of the night and washed their stripes, and was immediately baptized, he and all his household. ³⁴ He brought them up into his house and set food before them, and rejoiced greatly, with all his household, having believed in God.

Because Paul and Silas stayed:

- The jailer falls down and asks how to be saved.
- He and his whole family hear about Jesus.
- That same night they were **baptized**.
- The jailer washes the wounds of the same men he once guarded.

Their pain became the door to someone else's **salvation**.

Reflection Question

Can you think of a time when God used something hard in your life to help or encourage someone else?

Dessert

Paul and Silas show us:

- You can be in a dark place **and** still choose faith.
- God can turn a prison into a place of praise and a place of salvation.

Reflection Question

Complete this: “God, in my dark moments, help me to choose _____ instead of _____.”

To-Go Box

- Doing the right thing doesn’t always lead to easy places, but God is still there.
- Your worship in hard times is louder than you think—people are listening.
- God can use your midnight to bring someone else into the light.

Write _____ one _____ sentence:

“Lord, help me remember that You are still with me even when I feel _____.”

Prayer

“Lord, thank You for Paul and Silas. When life feels unfair or dark, remind me that You are still worthy of praise. Help me not to give up on You when things hurt. Use my faith in tough times to point other people to You. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Personal Prayer Space

Write a short prayer about a “midnight” area in your life where you want to trust God more:

Activity – “Midnight Playlist”

Write down:

1. One worship song that helps you trust God when you’re sad or stressed:

2. One verse from this lesson (or another) you can hold onto in a dark time:

3. You can use these as your “**midnight tools**” the next time things feel heavy.



Notes Section — Group Discussion & Personal Study

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Appendix – Breakfast Month 1 (YE) Answer Key

Theme: Prayer, the First Resort



Lesson 1 – Esther: Second Is the Best

1. Vashti
2. Mordecai
3. time
4. Fast



Lesson 2 - Solomon: Wisdom in Response

1. God appeared to **Solomon** in a dream and said, “Ask for what you want Me to give you.”
2. Solomon asked for an **understanding heart** to judge God’s people.
3. God was **pleased** that Solomon asked for wisdom instead of riches or revenge.
4. In Proverbs 2, we are told to seek **wisdom** like silver and hidden treasure.



Lesson 3 - Jesus



Activity – “First Response Check” (Youth)

(Personal responses, for open discussion ...no wrong answers)



Lesson 4 - Paul & Silas



Activity – “Midnight Playlist” (Youth)

(Personal responses, for open discussion ...no wrong answers)

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